GRADE 5 ELA

Topic 4: Grammar, Language, and Vocabulary

Question Bank • Common Core-aligned to L.5.1–L.5.6

150 multiple-choice questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Includes randomized answer choices and a complete answer key.

Student: _____ Date: _____

Easy Questions

1. Which word joins the two ideas? “I wanted to play, ___ it began to rain.”

A. under
B. but
C. quickly
D. because

2. Which word shows where the cat is? “The cat hid ___ the table.”

A. although
B. bright
C. under
D. sing

3. Which word is an interjection? “Wow! That tower is tall.”

A. tall
B. that
C. Wow
D. tower

4. Choose the verb that completes the sentence: “Yesterday, we ___ the science museum.”

A. visited
B. will visit
C. visiting
D. visit

5. Choose the correct verb: “The basket of apples ___ on the counter.”

A. were
B. be
C. is
D. are

6. Choose the pronoun that agrees with “The girls.”

A. they
B. it
C. she
D. he

7. Which word is the adjective? “The narrow path crossed the field.”

A. crossed
B. narrow
C. field
D. path

8. Which word tells how the bird sang? “The bird sang sweetly.”

A. bird
B. sweetly
C. sang
D. the

9. Which is an abstract noun?

A. courage
B. window
C. pencil
D. backpack

10. Which word names a group?

A. nest
B. wing
C. flock
D. feather

11. What is the plural of “mouse”?

A. mouses
B. mice
C. mices
D. mousees

12. Which word completes the sentence? “Please put the books over ___.”

A. thare
B. their
C. they’re
D. there

13. Which sentence uses capitalization correctly?

A. My aunt lives in Lagos.
B. My aunt lives in lagos.
C. my Aunt lives in lagos.
D. My Aunt lives in Lagos.

14. Which sentence uses commas correctly in a series?

A. We packed socks shirts, and hats.
B. We packed, socks, shirts and hats.
C. We packed socks, shirts, and hats.
D. We packed socks, shirts and, hats.

15. Which sentence correctly punctuates dialogue?

A. Mina said, “I found my notebook”.
B. Mina said, “I found my notebook.”
C. Mina said, I found my notebook.
D. Mina said “I found my notebook”.

16. Which word can begin a clause describing a person?

A. who
B. where
C. when
D. which

17. Which word best completes the sentence? “That is the park ___ we met.”

A. what
B. who
C. where
D. whose

18. “The glass was fragile, so Kai carried it carefully.” What does “fragile” mean?

A. very heavy
B. hard to find
C. brightly colored
D. easily broken

19. Which word is closest in meaning to “enormous”?

A. quiet
B. huge
C. narrow
D. tiny

20. Which word is the opposite of “ancient”?

A. historic
B. early
C. old
D. modern

21. What does the prefix “un-” usually mean in “unfair”?

A. not
B. again
C. before
D. full of

22. What does “-less” mean in “careless”?

A. full of
B. able to
C. one who
D. without

23. In “transport,” the root “port” relates to carrying. Which word also uses this root?

A. portrait
B. portion
C. porch
D. portable

24. Which reference tool is best for finding a word’s meaning?

A. dictionary
B. recipe
C. atlas
D. calendar

25. Which tool helps you find synonyms for “happy”?

A. timeline
B. index
C. thesaurus
D. globe

26. Choose the correct past-tense verb: “She ___ the door gently.”

A. closed
B. closing
C. close
D. closes

27. Which word best joins the ideas? “We stayed inside ___ the storm was strong.”

A. because
B. unless
C. or
D. yet

28. Which word completes the sentence? “The plane flew ___ the clouds.”

A. above
B. read
C. unless
D. cheerful

29. Choose the pronoun that replaces “Maya and I.”

A. they
B. we
C. us
D. she

30. Which adjective best completes the sentence? “The ___ puppy slept.”

A. sleepily
B. slept
C. sleepy
D. sleep

31. Choose the adverb: “The team worked carefully.”

A. team
B. carefully
C. worked
D. the

32. Which sentence ends with the correct punctuation for a question?

A. Where did you put the key.
B. Where did you put the key,
C. Where did you put the key!
D. Where did you put the key?

33. Which is a proper noun?

A. current
B. river
C. River Niger
D. water

34. Which is a common noun?

A. Mrs. Bello
B. Monday
C. Nigeria
D. teacher

35. Which sentence is in the future tense?

A. We visit the farm often.
B. We are visiting the farm now.
C. We will visit the farm tomorrow.
D. We visited the farm yesterday.

36. What does “they’re” mean?

A. they were
B. their
C. there are
D. they are

37. Which word completes the sentence? “The sun is ___ today.”

A. brigt
B. bride
C. brite
D. bright

38. The root “spect” relates to seeing. Which word contains it?

A. special
B. respectful
C. species
D. inspect

39. What does “hold your horses” usually mean?

A. wait patiently
B. care for animals
C. run quickly
D. speak loudly

40. “The stars danced” is an example of—

A. a fact
B. personification
C. a question
D. a command

41. Which word should be capitalized? “We went to ___ on Monday.”

A. went
B. school is not a proper noun
C. school
D. on

42. Which punctuation mark separates items in a list?

A. period
B. hyphen
C. apostrophe
D. comma

43. Choose the correct sentence.

A. The dogs bark at night.
B. The dogs is barking at night.
C. The dogs barks at night.
D. The dogs barking at night.

44. Which sentence uses a clear pronoun reference?

A. They said it was ready, but nobody knew what “it” meant.
B. Lola put the folder in her bag.
C. When it happened, she did that.
D. Lola told Ada she was late, but it was unclear who.

45. Which word describes the noun in “three blue kites”?

A. kites
B. three
C. blue
D. and

46. Which word tells when? “We will leave soon.”

A. leave
B. we
C. will
D. soon

47. What do guide words at the top of a dictionary page show?

A. the first and last entries on that page
B. the number of syllables only
C. the author and publisher
D. the book’s price

48. Which word means “to make something better”?

A. remove
B. ignore
C. improve
D. repeat

49. What does the prefix “re-” mean in “rewrite”?

A. not
B. again
C. under
D. before

50. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

A. please close the door.
B. Please close the door.
C. Please close the door,
D. Please close the door?

Medium Questions

1. Choose the pair that completes the sentence: “___ the coach ___ the players were ready.”

A. Both; and
B. Not only; but
C. Neither; or
D. Either; nor

2. Which sentence uses the present perfect tense?

A. She is finishing her model.
B. She finished her model.
C. She will finish her model.
D. She has finished her model.

3. Choose the sentence with consistent verb tense.

A. Nora opening the box and lifts out a map.
B. Nora opened the box and lifted out a map.
C. Nora will open the box and lifted out a map.
D. Nora opens the box and lifted out a map.

4. Choose the correct verb: “Each of the players ___ a water bottle.”

A. were
B. have
C. has
D. are having

5. Which sentence uses pronouns correctly?

A. The team put their bag away, and it were heavy.
B. Each student brought a book, and they placed his book on the shelf.
C. Each student brought a book, and the students placed their books on the shelf.
D. The children said he was ready.

6. Choose the relative pronoun: “The artist ___ painted this mural is visiting.”

A. when
B. who
C. where
D. why

7. Choose the best word: “We returned to the village ___ my father grew up.”

A. which
B. where
C. whose
D. who

8. In “The bicycle beside the gate belongs to Tola,” which phrase is prepositional?

A. belongs to Tola
B. The bicycle
C. to Tola belongs
D. beside the gate

9. Choose the correct word: “The runner moved ___ through the crowd.”

A. quieter
B. quietly
C. quiet
D. quietness

10. Choose the correct plural of “analysis.”

A. analysiseses
B. analyses
C. analysises
D. analysis

11. Which sentence uses the past perfect tense?

A. The bus had left before we reached the stop.
B. The bus leaves before we reached the stop.
C. The bus has left before we reached the stop.
D. The bus left before we reached the stop.

12. Which conjunction best shows contrast? “I was tired, ___ I finished the assignment.”

A. because
B. unless
C. yet
D. since

13. Which sentence correctly uses a comma after an introductory phrase?

A. After, the game we drank water.
B. After the game, we drank water.
C. After the game we, drank water.
D. After the game we drank, water.

14. Which sentence punctuates dialogue correctly?

A. “Please sit down” the teacher, said.
B. “Please sit down,” the teacher said.
C. Please sit down,” the teacher said.
D. “Please sit down”, the teacher said.

15. Which sentence is capitalized correctly?

A. We studied the History of Nigeria in april.
B. We studied the history of nigeria in April.
C. we studied the history of Nigeria in April.
D. We studied the history of Nigeria in April.

16. “Unlike her timid brother, Zainab was bold and spoke first.” What does “timid” mean?

A. generous
B. careless
C. shy
D. excited

17. The root “struct” means build. What does “reconstruct” mean?

A. build again
B. measure carefully
C. decorate with pictures
D. tear down completely

18. What does the prefix “mis-” mean in “misunderstand”?

A. before
B. between
C. many
D. wrongly or badly

19. What does “-able” mean in “washable”?

A. full of
B. one who
C. able to be
D. without

20. In “The exhausted hikers rested,” which word is closest to “exhausted”?

A. tired
B. curious
C. careful
D. delighted

21. Which word is the opposite of “scarce”?

A. rare
B. abundant
C. few
D. limited

22. “The classroom was a zoo” is an example of—

A. literal description
B. metaphor
C. simile
D. alliteration

23. Which sentence contains a simile?

A. The lake was glass.
B. The lake shone brightly.
C. The lake shone like glass.
D. The lake whispered at night.

24. What does “spill the beans” mean?

A. plant a garden
B. make a mess with food
C. cook dinner
D. reveal a secret

25. Which source is most useful for finding synonyms and antonyms?

A. thesaurus
B. dictionary pronunciation key
C. table of contents
D. glossary of a science book

26. Choose the correct word: “The hikers left ___ bags by the tree.”

A. their
B. they’re
C. theirs’
D. there

27. Choose the correct sentence.

A. The teacher gave the certificates to Amaka and myself.
B. The teacher gave the certificates to Amaka and I.
C. The teacher gave the certificates to I and Amaka.
D. The teacher gave the certificates to Amaka and me.

28. Choose the correct sentence.

A. The box of crayons be on the desk.
B. The box of crayons are on the desk.
C. The box of crayons were on the desk.
D. The box of crayons is on the desk.

29. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

A. “I can help,” said Kemi, “after I finish this page.”
B. “I can help” said Kemi “after I finish this page.”
C. “I can help” said Kemi, “after I finish this page.”
D. “I can help,” said Kemi “after I finish this page.”

30. Which sentence shows an action that began in the past and continues now?

A. I have lived here for three years.
B. I am living here tomorrow for three years.
C. I will live here for three years.
D. I lived here for three years, but I moved away.

31. Choose the phrase that sounds correct.

A. wooden three bowls small
B. three small wooden bowls
C. three wooden small bowls
D. small wooden three bowls

32. Which sentence uses a collective noun?

A. The stage was brightly lit.
B. A curtain covered the window.
C. The actor memorized a line.
D. The audience applauded after the play.

33. Which word names a quality rather than a person, place, or object?

A. river
B. helmet
C. market
D. honesty

34. Which conjunction best completes the sentence? “You may read ___ draw during free time.”

A. or
B. because
C. unless
D. although

35. Which word is a preposition in this sentence? “The bird flew through the open window.”

A. open
B. flew
C. bird
D. through

36. Which sentence avoids an unclear pronoun?

A. They said it was there.
B. When Tunde called Bisi, he asked about the meeting.
C. When Tunde called Bisi, Tunde asked about the meeting.
D. She told her that she had won.

37. “The trail was arduous; the steep climb left everyone exhausted.” What does “arduous” mean?

A. short
B. pleasant
C. difficult
D. familiar

38. What does “preview” mean?

A. view without
B. view incorrectly
C. view again
D. view before

39. In “carefully,” what does the suffix “-ly” help show?

A. a place where something happens
B. the manner in which an action is done
C. a person who does an action
D. the opposite of the root

40. Which sentence correctly uses an apostrophe to show possession?

A. The girls backpack is blue.
B. The girls' backpack is blue. (one girl)
C. The girl's backpack is blue.
D. The girl's' backpack is blue.

41. Choose the sentence with correct tense sequence.

A. By the time the bell rang, we packing our bags.
B. By the time the bell rings, we had packed our bags.
C. By the time the bell rang, we have packed our bags.
D. By the time the bell rang, we had packed our bags.

42. Which word best completes the sentence? “The book, ___ cover is torn, belongs to me.”

A. when
B. where
C. whose
D. who

43. Which word best replaces “said” in “Musa said the answer in a confident voice”?

A. borrowed
B. announced
C. forgot
D. hid

44. Choose the correct word: “Please ___ the answer carefully.”

A. write
B. wright
C. rite
D. right

45. The root “aud” relates to hearing. Which word uses this root?

A. author
B. autumn
C. audible
D. audience (as a crowd only)

46. Which word is an adverb of frequency?

A. often
B. bright
C. table
D. jumped

47. Which sentence is a command?

A. Place your papers on the desk.
B. Your papers are on the desk.
C. Where are your papers?
D. What a neat desk!

48. Which sentence correctly uses a colon to introduce a list?

A. Bring: three items a pencil, an eraser and a ruler.
B. Bring three items: a pencil, an eraser, and a ruler.
C. Bring three items, a pencil: an eraser, and a ruler.
D. Bring three items;: a pencil, an eraser, and a ruler.

49. Which word best means “to examine closely”?

A. ignore
B. scatter
C. inspect
D. delay

50. What can a dictionary pronunciation guide help you learn?

A. how to say a word
B. how many pages a book has
C. whether a story is fictional
D. who first used every word

Hard Questions

1. Which sentence uses the past perfect tense to show an earlier action?

A. By noon, the workers had repaired the fence.
B. By noon, the workers have repaired the fence.
C. By noon, the workers will repair the fence.
D. By noon, the workers repair the fence.

2. Which sentence maintains consistent verb tense?

A. Lena checks the measurements and recorded the results.
B. Lena checking the measurements and records the results.
C. Lena checked the measurements and records the results.
D. Lena checks the measurements and records the results.

3. Choose the correct verb: “Neither the captain nor the players ___ ready.”

A. was
B. be
C. is
D. are

4. Choose the correct pair: “___ the rain ___ the strong wind delayed the match.”

A. Whether; nor
B. Either; nor
C. Both; and
D. Neither; or

5. Which sentence has clear, correct pronoun agreement?

A. The members submitted his report before the deadline.
B. The members submitted their reports before the deadline.
C. The members submitted its report before the deadline.
D. The members submitted her report before the deadline.

6. Which sentence uses a relative pronoun correctly?

A. The engineer who designed the bridge explained its safety features.
B. The engineer when designed the bridge explained its safety features.
C. The engineer whose designed the bridge explained its safety features.
D. The engineer where designed the bridge explained its safety features.

7. Which sentence correctly punctuates a direct quotation?

A. “We are ready”, Amina replied.
B. “We are ready” Amina, replied.
C. We are ready,” Amina replied.
D. “We are ready,” Amina replied.

8. Which sentence correctly punctuates an introductory dependent clause?

A. Although, the road was muddy the bus arrived on time.
B. Although the road was muddy the bus, arrived on time.
C. Although the road, was muddy the bus arrived on time.
D. Although the road was muddy, the bus arrived on time.

9. “The instructions were ambiguous, so two groups interpreted them differently.” What does “ambiguous” mean?

A. open to more than one interpretation
B. written in a hurry
C. easy to follow
D. based on measurements

10. The root “bene” means good or well. What does “beneficial” most nearly mean?

A. likely to happen again
B. difficult to explain
C. helpful or producing good results
D. harmful or damaging

11. What does “disagreement” mean, based on its word parts?

A. a person who agrees
B. a lack of agreement
C. the act of agreeing fully
D. a repeated agreement

12. “The old house groaned in the wind” is an example of—

A. hyperbole
B. personification
C. alliteration
D. literal scientific description

13. Which sentence uses a metaphor?

A. Her voice sounded soft.
B. Her voice carried across the room.
C. Her voice was as soft as velvet.
D. Her voice was velvet.

14. Which sentence uses a simile to compare two things?

A. The ships crossed the sea beneath the clouds.
B. The clouds drifted like ships across the sky.
C. The clouds drifted slowly across the sky.
D. The clouds were ships across the sky.

15. In “After missing the bus, Jide had to face the music,” what does the idiom mean?

A. join a music class
B. listen to a song
C. avoid responsibility
D. accept the consequences

16. Which word best completes the sentence? “The scientist ___ the results to make sure they were accurate.”

A. postponed
B. verified
C. decorated
D. guessed

17. Choose the correct word: “The new policy will ___ every student.”

A. infect
B. affects
C. affect
D. effect

18. Choose the sentence with correct pronoun case.

A. Between yourself and I, the puzzle was difficult.
B. Between you and myself, the puzzle was difficult.
C. Between you and me, the puzzle was difficult.
D. Between you and I, the puzzle was difficult.

19. Choose the correct verb: “The list of materials ___ on the table.”

A. have
B. were
C. are
D. is

20. Which sentence uses the present perfect tense correctly?

A. They has already eaten lunch.
B. They have already eaten lunch.
C. They had already eat lunch.
D. They have already ate lunch.

21. Which sentence shows an action that was completed before another past action?

A. She locks the door before she leaves.
B. She had locked the door before she left.
C. She will lock the door before she left.
D. She has locked the door before she left.

22. Which sentence correctly uses a comma before a coordinating conjunction joining two independent clauses?

A. The sun set, because and the temperature dropped.
B. The sun set, and the temperature dropped.
C. The sun, set and the temperature dropped.
D. The sun set and, the temperature dropped.

23. Which sentence correctly places punctuation with quotation marks in standard American English?

A. Dad asked “Are you ready”?
B. Dad asked, “Are you ready”?
C. Dad asked, “Are you ready?”
D. Dad asked, “Are you ready.”

24. Which sentence correctly capitalizes a title and a proper noun?

A. We read “The Secret Garden” during our unit on Books.
B. We read “the Secret garden” during our unit on books.
C. We read “The Secret Garden” during our unit on books.
D. We read “The secret Garden” during our unit on books.

25. In “The bright lantern on the shelf lit the room,” which words form a prepositional phrase?

A. on the shelf
B. the room
C. lit the room
D. bright lantern

26. In “The unusually quiet class listened carefully,” which word modifies the adjective “quiet”?

A. listened
B. unusually
C. carefully
D. class

27. Choose the correct word: “The soup smells ___.”

A. deliciousness
B. deliciously
C. delicious
D. delight

28. Which sentence makes the pronoun’s antecedent clear?

A. When she saw her, she waved.
B. Mariam gave Sola the folder because she had finished using it.
C. Mariam gave the folder to Sola because Mariam had finished using it.
D. They put it there after they got it.

29. Choose the best word: “That was the year ___ our school opened.”

A. when
B. who
C. whose
D. which

30. Which sentence correctly punctuates a list after an introductory phrase?

A. For the experiment we need, water soil, and three seeds.
B. For the experiment, we need water soil and, three seeds.
C. For the experiment, we need water, soil, and three seeds.
D. For the experiment we need water, soil and three, seeds.

31. “The speaker was concise and used only a few words.” What does “concise” mean?

A. loud and forceful
B. long and detailed
C. brief but clear
D. uncertain and hesitant

32. The root “cred” relates to believing. Which word means “able to be believed”?

A. credible
B. creditor
C. incredible (always believable)
D. creedless

33. “Although the path looked level, it was actually uneven, with dips and raised stones.” What does “uneven” mean?

A. well marked
B. not smooth or level
C. completely dry
D. very wide

34. Which word is the best antonym for “reluctant”?

A. uncertain
B. unwilling
C. hesitant
D. eager

35. Which word is closest in meaning to “meticulous”?

A. careful and precise
B. hurried
C. careless
D. ordinary

36. What does “break the ice” mean when people first meet?

A. damage a frozen lake
B. stop a conversation
C. end a friendship
D. make people feel more comfortable

37. “The wind whispered through the trees” suggests that the wind—

A. caused the trees to disappear
B. spoke using actual words
C. stopped moving completely
D. made a soft, whisper-like sound

38. You know a word’s meaning but want a more exact synonym for a formal report. Which tool should you consult?

A. a table of contents
B. an atlas
C. a thesaurus
D. a calendar

39. A dictionary page has guide words “manage–manner.” Where would “manual” most likely appear?

A. in the index of a thesaurus, not a dictionary
B. on a different page, because it comes after “manage” but before “manner” only if alphabetically placed there
C. before “manage,” because “m” is the first letter
D. after “manner,” because “manual” begins with “man”

40. Which sentence uses an apostrophe correctly for a plural possessive noun?

A. The players' uniforms were clean.
B. The player's uniforms were clean. (all players)
C. The players's uniforms were clean.
D. The players uniforms' were clean.

41. Choose the sentence with the clearest and correct tense sequence.

A. After the rain stopping, the children went outside.
B. After the rain stops, the children went outside.
C. After the rain stopped, the children went outside.
D. After the rain had stopped, the children go outside.

42. Choose the sentence that uses correlative conjunctions correctly.

A. Neither the map nor the compass was missing.
B. Neither the map or the compass was missing.
C. Either the map and the compass was missing.
D. Both the map nor the compass was missing.

43. What does “unpredictable” mean?

A. already explained clearly
B. able to be planned exactly
C. likely to happen at the same time every day
D. not able to be known or expected in advance

44. “The town imposed a temporary ban, which would last only until repairs were finished.” What does “temporary” mean?

A. lasting for a limited time
B. unnecessary
C. permanent
D. difficult to enforce

45. Which sentence includes a relative clause that describes a noun?

A. The book that you lent me was fascinating.
B. You lent me the book.
C. Fascinating books are popular.
D. The book was fascinating yesterday.

46. Which sentence correctly uses the past perfect tense?

A. By the time the guests arrived, we preparing dinner.
B. By the time the guests arrived, we had prepared dinner.
C. By the time the guests arrived, we have prepare dinner.
D. By the time the guests arrive, we had prepared dinner.

47. Which word best completes the sentence? “The evidence was ___, so the jury could understand it easily.”

A. incomplete
B. convincing
C. confusing
D. irrelevant

48. Which conjunction best completes the sentence? “The route was longer, ___ it was safer.”

A. but
B. unless
C. because
D. therefore (used without punctuation or restructuring)

49. Which tool would best help you confirm the spelling of “accommodate”?

A. a dictionary
B. a thesaurus
C. an atlas
D. a timeline

50. Which phrase is an example of alliteration?

A. wind across the water
B. the wind is strong
C. a very windy day
D. wild winds whistle

Answer Key

Each answer letter corresponds to the final randomized option order.

Easy

1. B 2. C 3. C 4. A 5. C 6. A 7. B 8. B 9. A 10. C
11. B 12. D 13. A 14. C 15. B 16. A 17. C 18. D 19. B 20. D
21. A 22. D 23. D 24. A 25. C 26. A 27. A 28. A 29. B 30. C
31. B 32. D 33. C 34. D 35. C 36. D 37. D 38. D 39. A 40. B
41. B 42. D 43. A 44. B 45. C 46. D 47. A 48. C 49. B 50. B

Medium

1. A 2. D 3. B 4. C 5. C 6. B 7. B 8. D 9. B 10. B
11. A 12. C 13. B 14. B 15. D 16. C 17. A 18. D 19. C 20. A
21. B 22. B 23. C 24. D 25. A 26. A 27. D 28. D 29. A 30. A
31. B 32. D 33. D 34. A 35. D 36. C 37. C 38. D 39. B 40. C
41. D 42. C 43. B 44. A 45. C 46. A 47. A 48. B 49. C 50. A

Hard

1. A 2. D 3. D 4. C 5. B 6. A 7. D 8. D 9. A 10. C
11. B 12. B 13. D 14. B 15. D 16. B 17. C 18. C 19. D 20. B
21. B 22. B 23. C 24. C 25. A 26. B 27. C 28. C 29. A 30. C
31. C 32. A 33. B 34. D 35. A 36. D 37. D 38. C 39. B 40. A
41. C 42. A 43. D 44. A 45. A 46. B 47. B 48. A 49. A 50. D